

CLASS MATERIAL

WEEK 4

CEL2103 WRITING ACADEMIC TEXTS
SEMESTER 2, 2024-2025

Developing Introductory Paragraph in Comparison and Contrast Essay

- Components of an introductory paragraph of a compare and contrast essay
 - Thesis statement
- Language
 - Tenses and Subject-Verb Agreement

Components of an Introductory Paragraph: Thesis Statement

A thesis statement is an important component in an introductory paragraph of a compare and contrast essay.

Activity 1

What is the purpose of a thesis statement in a compare and contrast essay?

Activity 2

What are some characteristics of an effective thesis statement for a compare and contrast essay?

- a. _____
- b. _____
- c. _____

Activity 3

Below are thesis statements for compare and contrast essays.

- i. Underline and label the subjects (S)*
- ii. Underline and label the points of comparison that will be discussed (P)*
- iii. Underline and label the transition signal used to compare the subjects (T)*

Example:

While (T) high school and college (S) are similar in terms of studying process (P), they have different environment (P).

1. Although authoritative and permissive parenting styles have a similarity where parents who practise the parenting styles are responsive, these parenting styles are complete opposite especially about setting up rules.

2. Coke and Pepsi share the same nutritional content, but their advertising approach is different.
3. While many public and private schools have similar school administration, they differ in the aspect of funding.
4. Hitler and Stalin were both powerful leaders, but they caused different impacts on World War II.

Activity 4

Below are poorly written compare and contrast thesis statements. Identify the reasons and rewrite the thesis statements.

1. Living in an urban and rural area are similar in some ways but different in others.

Reason: _____

Correction: _____

2. Plan A and Plan B offer inexpensive and good line reception with no binding contracts; moreover, Plan B offers better value for the money for people who do not have a landline.

Reason: _____

Correction: _____

3. Electric vehicles and biodiesel vehicles share some similarities as both have better fuel economy and energy security.

Reason: _____

Correction: _____

4. Coffee and tea seem to be very different. They are quite similar in some ways.

Reason: _____

Correction: _____

5. Although online classes may require a great amount of work, they allow better flexibility.

Reason: _____

Correction: _____

Activity 5

Write a thesis statement for each of the topics below.

Topic 1: Similarities and differences of attending public school and home school

Topic 2: A comparison between the benefits of medicines and natural remedies

Topic 3: The similarities and differences between e-books and textbooks

Language: Tenses

Using the correct tenses is important to make your writing clearer.

Activity 6

Which tense would you use in the following situations?

Situation	Tense
A common knowledge	
What happened in an experiment	
Ideas that were held in the past	
Something that has changed over time	

Someone's opinion	
The results of an experiment	
A habitual action in the present	
Recent research and its present impact	
A theory	
A claim which is no longer valid	
A fact	

Activity 7

Fill in the blanks with the correct tenses (simple present / simple past / present perfect) of the verbs in the parenthesis.

The Covid crisis _____ (make) people to work from home, so all the learning activities had to take place online. However, is it a good substitute for traditional learning? Online learning takes place over the internet and _____ (be) a form of distance learning. It can be teacher lead at a specific time (synchronous) or student-paced working through the material unguided (asynchronous). Content can be delivered as text, images and video, and features could include online assessment or interactive activities. Traditional learning occurs in a classroom with a teacher who _____ (plan) and _____ (present) a particular topic lesson. The teacher can use various educational tools such as introducing information on a chalk or whiteboard, student presentations, group or partner work, and individual exercises or activities. Class quizzes, informal assessments and homework assignments can be set. Both online learning and traditional learning require students to use study materials, but they differ in flexibility.

Both online learning and traditional learning need students to use study materials. These students typically _____ (has) Internet access, so websites and research materials are equally available. For example, textbooks and online resources are used for classroom assignments. Textbooks used are the same for both types of learning, so there _____ (be) no discrepancy in content. It is the requirement for the students in both styles of learning to use course textbooks to prepare for and complete their reading and writing assignments.

Even though a course may be taken online, textbooks are still central to learning relevant information. Some courses, however, may allow the students to purchase the material in an 'e-book' format, which is an electronic book. Whether they buy the material as an e-book or as a hardcover book, they will have to learn and use the materials. Smith (2020) _____ (identify) that whether online classes or traditional physical setting, students will be assigned homework to complete. Like traditional courses, students are expected to do a series of reading and writing assignments relevant to the course they _____ (enrol) in.

Although there is a similarity in study materials, online learning and traditional learning are different in terms of flexibility. A traditional learning _____ (take) place at a specific location and a set time. For example, the teacher _____ (give) the students a timetable of their classes for the week, so the teacher will expect them to attend the course at the specified time. The students will have missed the teacher's lesson if they _____ (be, not) attend the class. However, there may be an opportunity to catch up on some work, but this catch-up work will, in most cases, not be of the same standard as the lesson presented. In some situations, if the students missed too many classes, they might not be allowed to sit for the final exam. This time dependency _____ (make) the traditional education approach difficult for some students with outside commitments, such as family or work. On the other hand, the online learning approach provides much-needed flexibility. Students can log into a course at any time of the day and _____ (complete) the course content at their own pace. They will receive the same lesson content as other students and not be penalised if they did not log in simultaneously. Communication in these courses can be asynchronous through an online forum, where students can leave messages and reply to other students at any point. Students can fit in their learning as and when they have the time for courses without a set completion date. Watson (2020) _____ (find) that most online courses have set completion requirements such as reading or viewing all material and completing an online assessment and not set times spent online. This means online learning _____ (offer) the flexibility for students who have full-time jobs or might need to care for a family member.

Adapted from: McNulty, N. (2021). *Online Education vs Traditional Education*.

<https://www.niallmcnulty.com/2021/04/what-is-the-difference-between-online-education-and-traditional-education/>

Language: Subject-verb Agreement

Activity 8

The text below contains TEN subject-verb agreement errors. Identify and correct the errors.

Although the function of formal and informal communication are similar in getting the message across in an organisation, they differ in the purpose of use. Formal communication channels are those channels which is specifically designed to pave ways of information flow in an organisation. Usually, these communication channel are included within the job descriptions of individual employees and general standard procedures of a business. The management is responsible for timely and accurate implementation of formal communication channels for smooth running of its organisations. Although informal communication channels exists in every organisation, they are not officially used. They serve as a medium for employees to meet their social, emotional and personal needs. Besides that, formal communication channels is developed to regulate the day-to-day operational activities of a business. Larger business recruit special officers or personnel for efficient and timely dispersal of information in all directions of the organisation including top-to-bottom and bottom-to-top. On the other hand, informal communication channels are unofficial and is not directly related to the day-to-day activities of the business; however, employees of an organisation uses these channels to perform their daily tasks along with formal communication channels. According to Harappa (2020) formal communication is also called official communication where formal communication often follow a specific structure or channels such as emails to the clients, whereas informal communication can often flow freely in any direction.

Adapted from: *Formal vs informal communication*. (2020). <https://www.termscompared.com/formal-vs-informal-communication/>